

BibInVs MN 36

Zephaniah

Bible Translation:

Interverse MSG/NIV - 36

God

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Interversed Message/NIV Bible

Zephaniah

Zephaniah 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD's Message to Zephaniah son of Cushi, son of Gedaliah, son of Amariah, son of Hezekiah. It came during the reign of Josiah son of Amon, who was king of Judah:
- 1 The word of the LORD that came to Zephaniah son of Cushi, the son of Gedaliah, the son of Amariah, the son of Hezekiah, during the reign of Josiah son of Amon king of Judah:
- 2 "I'm going to make a clean sweep of the earth, a thorough housecleaning." GOD's Decree.
- 2 I will sweep away everything from the face of the earth, declares the LORD.
- 3 "Men and women and animals, including birds and fish-- Anything and everything that causes sin--will go, but especially people.
- 3 I will sweep away both men and animals; I will sweep away the birds of the air and the fish of the sea. The wicked will have only heaps of rubble when I cut off man from the face of the earth, declares the LORD.
- 4 "I'll start with Judah and everybody who lives in Jerusalem. I'll sweep the place clean of every trace of the sex-and-religion Baal shrines and their priests.
- 4 I will stretch out my hand against Judah and against all who live in Jerusalem. I will cut off from this place every remnant of Baal, the names of the pagan and the idolatrous priests--
- 5 I'll get rid of the people who sneak up to their rooftops at night to worship the star gods and goddesses; Also those who continue to worship GOD but cover their bases by worshiping other king-gods as well;
- 5 those who bow down on the roofs to worship the starry host, those who bow down and swear by the LORD and who also swear by Molech,

- 6 Not to mention those who've dumped GOD altogether, no longer giving him a thought or offering a prayer.
- 6 those who turn back from following the LORD and neither seek the LORD nor inquire of him.
- 7 "Quiet now! Reverent silence before me, GOD, the Master! Time's up. My Judgment Day is near: The Holy Day is all set, the invited guests made holy.
- 7 Be silent before the Sovereign LORD, for the day of the LORD is near. The LORD has prepared a sacrifice; he has consecrated those he has invited.
- 8 On the Holy Day, GOD's Judgment Day, I will punish the leaders and the royal sons; I will punish those who dress up like foreign priests and priestesses,
- 8 On the day of the LORD's sacrifice I will punish the princes and the king's sons and all those clad in foreign clothes.
- 9 Who introduce pagan prayers and practices; And I'll punish all who import pagan superstitions that turn holy places into hellholes.
- 9 On that day I will punish all who avoid stepping on the threshold, who fill the temple of their gods with violence and deceit.
- 10 Judgment Day!" GOD's Decree! "Cries of panic from the city's Fish Gate, Cries of terror from the city's Second Quarter, sounds of great crashing from the hills!
- 10 On that day, declares the LORD, "a cry will go up from the Fish Gate, wailing from the New Quarter, and a loud crash from the hills.
- 11 Wail, you shopkeepers on Market Street! Moneymaking has had its day. The god Money is dead.
- 11 Wail, you who live in the market district; all your merchants will be wiped out, all who trade with silver will be ruined.
- 12 On Judgment Day, I'll search through every closet and alley in Jerusalem. I'll find and punish those who are sitting it out, fat and lazy, amusing themselves and taking it easy, Who think, 'GOD doesn't do anything, good or bad. He isn't involved, so neither are we.'
- 12 At that time I will search Jerusalem with lamps and punish those who are complacent, who are like wine left on its dregs, who think, 'The LORD will do nothing, either good or bad.'

- 13 But just wait. They'll lose everything they have, money and house and land. They'll build a house and never move in. They'll plant vineyards and never taste the wine.
- 13 Their wealth will be plundered, their houses demolished. They will build houses but not live in them; they will plant vineyards but not drink the wine.
- 14 "The Great Judgment Day of GOD is almost here. It's countdown time: . . . seven, six, five, four . . . Bitter and noisy cries on my Judgment Day, even strong men screaming for help.
- 14 The great day of the LORD is near-- near and coming quickly. Listen! The cry on the day of the LORD will be bitter, the shouting of the warrior there.
- 15 Judgment Day is payday--my anger paid out: a day of distress and anguish, a day of catastrophic doom, a day of darkness at noon, a day of black storm clouds,
- 15 That day will be a day of wrath, a day of distress and anguish, a day of trouble and ruin, a day of darkness and gloom, a day of clouds and blackness,
- 16 a day of bloodcurdling war cries, as forts are assaulted, as defenses are smashed.
- 16 a day of trumpet and battle cry against the fortified cities and against the corner towers.
- 17 I'll make things so bad they won't know what hit them. They'll walk around groping like the blind. They've sinned against GOD! Their blood will be poured out like old dishwater, their guts shoveled into slop buckets.
- 17 I will bring distress on the people and they will walk like blind men, because they have sinned against the LORD. Their blood will be poured out like dust and their entrails like filth.
- 18 Don't plan on buying your way out. Your money is worthless for this. This is the Day of GOD's Judgment--my wrath! I care about sin with fiery passion-- A fire to burn up the corrupted world, a wildfire finish to the corrupting people."
- 18 Neither their silver nor their gold will be able to save them on the day of the LORD's wrath. In the fire of his jealousy the whole world will be consumed, for he will make a sudden end of all who live in the earth."

Zephaniah 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 So get yourselves together. Shape up! You're a nation without a clue about what it wants.
- 1 Gather together, gather together, O shameful nation,
- 2 Do it before you're blown away like leaves in a windstorm, Before GOD's Judgment-anger sweeps down on you, Before GOD's Judgment Day wrath descends with full force.
- 2 before the appointed time arrives and that day sweeps on like chaff, before the fierce anger of the LORD comes upon you, before the day of the LORD's wrath comes upon you.
- 3 Seek GOD, all you quietly disciplined people who live by GOD's justice. Seek GOD's right ways. Seek a quiet and disciplined life. Perhaps you'll be hidden on the Day of GOD's anger.
- 3 Seek the LORD, all you humble of the land, you who do what he commands. Seek righteousness, seek humility; perhaps you will be sheltered on the day of the LORD's anger.
- 4 Gaza is scheduled for demolition, Ashdod will be cleaned out by high noon, Ekron pulled out by the roots.
- 4 Gaza will be abandoned and Ashkelon left in ruins. At midday Ashdod will be emptied and Ekron uprooted.
- 5 Doom to the seaside people, the seafaring people from Crete! The Word of GOD is bad news for you who settled Canaan, the Philistine country: "You're slated for destruction-- no survivors!"
- 5 Woe to you who live by the sea, O Kerethite people; the word of the LORD is against you, O Canaan, land of the Philistines. "I will destroy you, and none will be left."
- 6 The lands of the seafarers will become pastureland, A country for shepherds and sheep.
- 6 The land by the sea, where the Kerethites dwell, will be a place for shepherds and sheep pens.
- 7 What's left of the family of Judah will get it. Day after day they'll pasture by the sea, and go home in the evening to Ashkelon to sleep. Their very own GOD will look out for them. He'll make things as good as before.

- 7 It will belong to the remnant of the house of Judah; there they will find pasture. In the evening they will lie down in the houses of Ashkelon. The LORD their God will care for them; he will restore their fortunes.
- 8 "I've heard the crude taunts of Moab, the mockeries flung by Ammon, The cruel talk they've used to put down my people, their self-important strutting along Israel's borders.
- 8 I have heard the insults of Moab and the taunts of the Ammonites, who insulted my people and made threats against their land.
- 9 Therefore, as sure as I am the living God," says GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, Israel's personal God, "Moab will become a ruin like Sodom, Ammon a ghost town like Gomorrah, One a field of rocks, the other a sterile salt flat, a moonscape forever. What's left of my people will finish them off, will pick them clean and take over.
- 9 Therefore, as surely as I live," declares the LORD Almighty, the God of Israel, "surely Moab will become like Sodom, the Ammonites like Gomorrah-- a place of weeds and salt pits, a wasteland forever. The remnant of my people will plunder them; the survivors of my nation will inherit their land."
- 10 This is what they get for their bloated pride, their taunts and mockeries of the people of GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies.
- 10 This is what they will get in return for their pride, for insulting and mocking the people of the LORD Almighty.
- 11 GOD will be seen as truly terrible--a Holy Terror. All earth-made gods will shrivel up and blow away; And everyone, wherever they are, far or near, will fall to the ground and worship him.
- 11 The LORD will be awesome to them when he destroys all the gods of the land. The nations on every shore will worship him, every one in its own land.
- 12 Also you Ethiopians, you too will die--I'll see to it."
- 12 You too, O Cushites, will be slain by my sword.
- 13 Then GOD will reach into the north and destroy Assyria. He will waste Nineveh, leave her dry and treeless as a desert.
- 13 He will stretch out his hand against the north and destroy Assyria, leaving Nineveh utterly desolate and dry as the desert.
- 14 The ghost town of a city, the haunt of wild animals, Nineveh will be home to raccoons and coyotes-- they'll bed down in its ruins. Owls will

- hoot in the windows, ravens will croak in the doorways-- all that fancy
woodwork now a perch for birds.
- 14 Flocks and herds will lie down there, creatures of every kind. The desert
owl and the screech owl will roost on her columns. Their calls will echo
through the windows, rubble will be in the doorways, the beams of cedar
will be exposed.
- 15 Can this be the famous Fun City that had it made, That boasted, "I'm the
Number-One City! I'm King of the Mountain!" So why is the place
deserted, a lair for wild animals? Passersby hardly give it a look; they
dismiss it with a gesture.
- 15 This is the carefree city that lived in safety. She said to herself, "I am,
and there is none besides me." What a ruin she has become, a lair for
wild beasts! All who pass by her scoff and shake their fists.

Zephaniah 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 Doom to the rebellious city, the home of oppressors--Sewer City!
- 1 Woe to the city of oppressors, rebellious and defiled!
- 2 The city that wouldn't take advice, wouldn't accept correction, Wouldn't
trust GOD, wouldn't even get close to her own god!
- 2 She obeys no one, she accepts no correction. She does not trust in the
LORD, she does not draw near to her God.
- 3 Her very own leaders are rapacious lions, Her judges are rapacious
timber wolves out every morning prowling for a fresh kill.
- 3 Her officials are roaring lions, her rulers are evening wolves, who leave
nothing for the morning.
- 4 Her prophets are out for what they can get. They're opportunists--you
can't trust them. Her priests desecrate the Sanctuary. They use God's law
as a weapon to maim and kill souls.
- 4 Her prophets are arrogant; they are treacherous men. Her priests profane
the sanctuary and do violence to the law.
- 5 Yet GOD remains righteous in her midst, untouched by the evil. He stays
at it, day after day, meting out justice. At evening he's still at it, strong as

ever. But evil men and women, without conscience and without shame, persist in evil.

- 5 The LORD within her is righteous; he does no wrong. Morning by morning he dispenses his justice, and every new day he does not fail, yet the unrighteous know no shame.
- 6 "So I cut off the godless nations. I knocked down their defense posts, Filled her roads with rubble so no one could get through. Her cities were bombed-out ruins, unlivable and unlived in.
- 6 I have cut off nations; their strongholds are demolished. I have left their streets deserted, with no one passing through. Their cities are destroyed; no one will be left--no one at all.
- 7 "I thought, 'Surely she'll honor me now, accept my discipline and correction, Find a way of escape from the trouble she's in, find relief from the punishment I'm bringing.' But it didn't faze her. Bright and early she was up at it again, doing the same old things.
- 7 I said to the city, 'Surely you will fear me and accept correction!' Then her dwelling would not be cut off, nor all my punishments come upon her. But they were still eager to act corruptly in all they did.
- 8 "Well, if that's what you want, stick around." GOD's Decree. "Your day in court is coming, but remember I'll be there to bring evidence. I'll bring all the nations to the courtroom, round up all the kingdoms, And let them feel the brunt of my anger, my raging wrath. My zeal is a fire that will purge and purify the earth.
- 8 Therefore wait for me," declares the LORD, "for the day I will stand up to testify. I have decided to assemble the nations, to gather the kingdoms and to pour out my wrath on them-- all my fierce anger. The whole world will be consumed by the fire of my jealous anger.
- 9 "In the end I will turn things around for the people. I'll give them a language undistorted, unpolluted, Words to address GOD in worship and, united, to serve me with their shoulders to the wheel.
- 9 Then will I purify the lips of the peoples, that all of them may call on the name of the LORD and serve him shoulder to shoulder.
- 10 They'll come from beyond the Ethiopian rivers, they'll come praying-- All my scattered, exiled people will come home with offerings for worship.

- 10 From beyond the rivers of Cush my worshipers, my scattered people, will bring me offerings.
- 11 You'll no longer have to be ashamed of all those acts of rebellion. I'll have gotten rid of your arrogant leaders. No more pious strutting on my holy hill!
- 11 On that day you will not be put to shame for all the wrongs you have done to me, because I will remove from this city those who rejoice in their pride. Never again will you be haughty on my holy hill.
- 12 I'll leave a core of people among you who are poor in spirit-- What's left of Israel that's really Israel. They'll make their home in GOD.
- 12 But I will leave within you the meek and humble, who trust in the name of the LORD.
- 13 This core holy people will not do wrong. They won't lie, won't use words to flatter or seduce. Content with who they are and where they are, unanxious, they'll live at peace."
- 13 The remnant of Israel will do no wrong; they will speak no lies, nor will deceit be found in their mouths. They will eat and lie down and no one will make them afraid."
- 14 So sing, Daughter Zion! Raise the rafters, Israel! Daughter Jerusalem, be happy! celebrate!
- 14 Sing, O Daughter of Zion; shout aloud, O Israel! Be glad and rejoice with all your heart, O Daughter of Jerusalem!
- 15 GOD has reversed his judgments against you and sent your enemies off chasing their tails. From now on, GOD is Israel's king, in charge at the center. There's nothing to fear from evil ever again!
- 15 The LORD has taken away your punishment, he has turned back your enemy. The LORD, the King of Israel, is with you; never again will you fear any harm.
- 16 Jerusalem will be told: "Don't be afraid. Dear Zion, don't despair.
- 16 On that day they will say to Jerusalem, "Do not fear, O Zion; do not let your hands hang limp.
- 17 Your GOD is present among you, a strong Warrior there to save you. Happy to have you back, he'll calm you with his love and delight you with his songs.
- 17 The LORD your God is with you, he is mighty to save. He will take great delight in you, he will quiet you with his love, he will rejoice over

you with singing."

18 "The accumulated sorrows of your exile will dissipate. I, your God, will get rid of them for you. You've carried those burdens long enough.

18 The sorrows for the appointed feasts I will remove from you; they are a burden and a reproach to you.

19 At the same time, I'll get rid of all those who've made your life miserable. I'll heal the maimed; I'll bring home the homeless. In the very countries where they were hated they will be venerated.

19 At that time I will deal with all who oppressed you; I will rescue the lame and gather those who have been scattered. I will give them praise and honor in every land where they were put to shame.

20 On Judgment Day I'll bring you back home--a great family gathering! You'll be famous and honored all over the world. You'll see it with your own eyes-- all those painful partings turned into reunions!" GOD's Promise.

20 At that time I will gather you; at that time I will bring you home. I will give you honor and praise among all the peoples of the earth when I restore your fortunes before your very eyes," says the LORD.